Learn Words About a New Subject

Directions The passage looks like an entry you might read in a biographical encyclopedia about great leaders. As you read it, think about how each new boldface content word relates to the big idea.

Martin Luther King, Jr.: A Great Leader

Martin Luther King, Jr., is honored as a great leader of the American Civil Rights movement. He was a champion for equal justice under the law. Through his years of **persistence**, Dr. King used peaceful protest to gain equal rights under the law for all people.



Martin Luther King, Jr., Civil Rights Leader and Hero for All Americans

Born in Atlanta, Georgia, in 1929, Dr. King became a minister when he was only seventeen years old. Through his studies, Dr. King learned of the Indian leader Mohandas Gandhi and his ideas of nonviolent protest. He learned that nonviolent action can be a powerful force for change.

Dr. King taught the importance of **self-discipline** and self-control in the fight to overcome injustice. People followed him because he was **trustworthy**. They knew he was honest and they could depend on him. As leader of the Montgomery bus boycott in 1955–1956, Dr. King brought people from all over America together because of his fair and honest leadership. He taught people the importance of **cooperation** in working toward a common goal.

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Vocabulary Words

compassion
cooperation
persistence
self-discipline
trustworthy

Word Learning Tip!

When you read about a new subject, you may see new content words that you have not seen before in your everyday reading. These words are often the longest and most difficult words in the text. They tell something specific about the subject you are reading. To learn these new words, think about the big idea or subject of the paragraph. In this lesson, all of the content words are about great leaders.

Vocabulary Building Strategy

To learn the meaning of content words about a new subject, make connections between the unknown word and the big idea or subject of what you are reading. The new word will tell something specific about the big idea. Tie together the big idea and the meanings of other content words that you know to determine the exact meaning of an unknown content word.

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Learn Words About a New Subject

compassion **cooperation** **persistence** **self-discipline** **trustworthy**

Another of Dr. King's successes was the March on Washington, DC, in 1963. He worked hard to organize this march and to get people to show **cooperation**. His **persistence** paid off. Over 200,000 people marched to demand racial equality. Keeping a demonstration of such a massive size peaceful demanded **self-discipline** from all who marched, but the marchers followed Dr. King's example.

"Make a career of humanity. Commit yourself to the noble struggle for human rights. You will make a greater person of yourself, a greater nation of your country, and a finer world to live in."

Martin Luther King, Jr.

Dr. King is also famous for his **compassion**. A moving speaker, he preached the importance of forgiveness and mercy. His dream was of a nation where all people were treated fairly and lived together peacefully. In 1964, Dr. Martin Luther King, Jr., was awarded the Nobel Peace Prize.

"But I know, somehow, that only when it is dark enough can you see the stars."

Martin Luther King, Jr.

Dr. King's memory lives on. His birthday, January 15, is celebrated each year as an American holiday. It is a day when people of all races get together in the spirit of **cooperation** and sharing. It honors both the man who brought hope to so many people and the qualities his life so clearly displayed—**compassion**, **trustworthiness**, **self-discipline**, and **persistence**.

"Love builds up and unites; hate tears down and destroys."

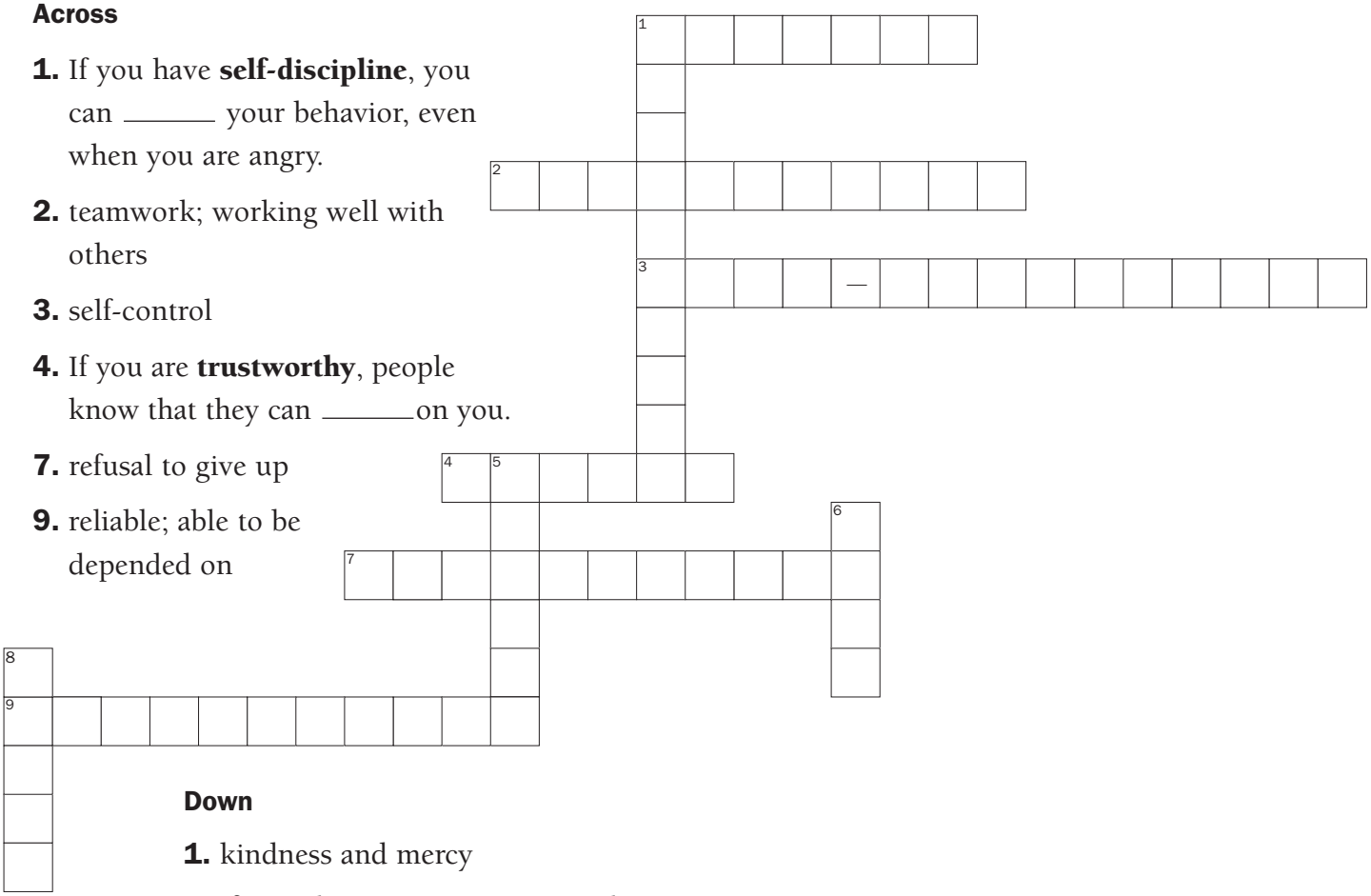
Martin Luther King, Jr.

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Connect Words and Meanings

compassion	cooperation	persistence	self-discipline	trustworthy

Directions Complete the crossword puzzle. Some of the clues give you definitions for the vocabulary words and some ask you to complete a sentence to show you understand the meaning of the vocabulary word. You may use your dictionary or the glossary to help you.



Across

1. If you have **self-discipline**, you can _____ your behavior, even when you are angry.

2. teamwork; working well with others

3. self-control

4. If you are **trustworthy**, people know that they can _____on you.

7. refusal to give up

9. reliable; able to be depended on

Down

1. kindness and mercy

5. If you show **persistence**, you don't give up _____.

6. If you show **cooperation**, you work _____ with others.

8. If you show **compassion**, you care about the feelings of _____ people.

Understand Famous Sayings Leaders often say memorable things, such as Franklin Roosevelt's famous sentence: "We have nothing to fear but fear itself." Write five sentences that a leader might use in an important speech about freedom. Each sentence should use one of the five vocabulary words. Make your sentences easy to understand so they are memorable.

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Use Content Words

compassion	cooperation	persistence	self-discipline	trustworthy

Directions Great leaders often face big problems. They solve these problems by using their skills and the help of others. Use your content words to complete the sentences about great leaders below. The boldface words in each sentence will help you. You will use each word twice.

1. In World War II, Winston Churchill, Franklin Roosevelt, and Joseph Stalin showed _____ and **worked together** to defeat the Nazis.

2. Soldiers knew nurse Florence Nightingale would take care of them because she promised she would. She was _____ and **reliable**.

3. Mohandas Gandhi went on hunger strikes to gain India's freedom. He was famous for his _____, as shown by his **self-control**.

4. Nelson Mandela showed _____ in trying for decades to get equal rights for black South Africans. He would **not give up**.

5. President John F. Kennedy showed _____ and **concern for others** when he started the Peace Corps.

6. When he took office, Harry Truman used _____ and **teamwork** to end World War II.

7. As the Israeli Prime Minister, Golda Meir was a _____ leader whom people **relied on** to make Israel strong.

8. Eleanor Roosevelt **refused to give up**! She used _____ to convince her husband, the president, to help poor people.

Understand Leadership Words Many important words about leadership start with the word *self*. Examples include *self-assurance*, *self-confidence*, and *self-control*. Define these three words. Then, find three new content area words that describe leaders. Use the Word Learning Tip and the Vocabulary Building Strategy to learn these words and write a sentence using each.

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Put Words Into Action

compassion	cooperation	persistence	self-discipline	trustworthy

Directions How do companies hire their leaders? They advertise! Use your content words to complete this advertisement for a leader. You will use each word twice.



PrimaCo

President Wanted for International Company

PrimaCo, a large, international company, is looking for a new president. The person chosen must be **1.**_____ and reliable. A good president will also understand the importance of **2.**_____ and working well with others.

3._____ is also important, especially the ability to stay cool in tense and stressful situations. The person must also have **4.**_____ to get the job done and show sympathy or **5.**_____ for workers' problems.

If you have self-control, or **6.**_____, and are **7.**_____ and dependable, you might be the new president we seek. Since there is a lot of teamwork involved with this job, working well with others, or **8.**_____, is also important. We are a company that values a leader who shows **9.**_____ for its workers. If you are determined and have **10.**_____, give us a call today at 555-7167.



Write a Letter of Application Imagine that you have decided to apply for the job as the new president of PrimaCo. Write your letter of application to the company. In the letter, describe the traits that make you a good leader. Use at least three of your vocabulary words in the letter.

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Review and Extend

compassion	cooperation	persistence	self-discipline	trustworthy

Bonus Words Below are two more words about great leaders. Remember that these words are about the same big idea: great leaders. As a result, you can figure out what these words mean by linking them to the big idea and to the other vocabulary words about leaders that you have learned.

loyalty being faithful and loyal
adaptable being able to adjust, or adapt, to different conditions

Directions Below are five questions about leadership. Answer each question with one of the vocabulary words or bonus words. You will use each content word once.

1. These leaders have the ability to put themselves in the other person's place and feel mercy and pity for them. What trait do these leaders have? _____
2. These leaders follow through on their promises and keep their friendships. What trait do these leaders have? _____
3. These leaders don't let setbacks discourage them from getting the job done. They stick with their task. What trait do these leaders have? _____
4. These leaders change their tactics to adjust to different conditions. What word would you use to describe these leaders? _____
5. These leaders understand the importance of teamwork and work well with others. What behavior do these leaders exhibit? _____

Bonus Think about this motto: When at first you don't succeed, try, try again. Write one or two sentences showing how this motto highlights two traits of good leaders.

_____

_____

Give a Leadership Award Choose a famous leader, past or present. List ten words that show why you admire this person. Then write a speech explaining why this leader deserves a leadership award.

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Check Your Mastery

Directions Read each item below. Circle the letter of the vocabulary word that best completes each sentence. Use each vocabulary word only once.

1. Leaders who have _____ follow a task to the end, even if they get discouraged.
A. persistence **B.** cooperation **C.** compassion

2. _____ is an important aspect of leadership, because it is hard to complete big tasks without teamwork and the help of others.
A. Compassion **B.** Self-discipline **C.** Cooperation

3. A _____ leader can be counted on to keep secrets, be honest with money, and not betray people.
A. cooperation **B.** trustworthy **C.** persistence

4. Great leaders need _____ because it helps them forgive mistakes that people make.
A. persistence **B.** compassion **C.** cooperation

5. There's no doubt that _____ is a key quality in a leader because without self-control, it's hard to stay on task.
A. compassion **B.** cooperation **C.** self-discipline

Directions Read the passage below. Then select the vocabulary word that best fits the context. Write the word in the blank. Use each vocabulary word only once.

Clara Barton, born in 1821, was a leader in three different fields! She is famous for her kindness and **6.**_____ (*persistence, self-discipline, compassion*) as a battlefield nurse. She is also well known as a teacher who taught her students to stay focused and in control of their actions. She wanted them to have **7.**_____ (*trustworthy, cooperation, self-discipline*). But Clara Barton's fame as a leader rests on her **8.**_____ (*persistence, trustworthy, compassion*) in establishing the American Red Cross. This was her biggest and most difficult battle because not everyone agreed that America needed an aid group to act in peacetime as well as in wartime. To establish the American Red Cross, Clara Barton needed the **9.**_____ (*compassion, persistence, cooperation)* of many people. She met with members of Congress, the president, and all his advisors. Because she had such a good reputation and was so **10.**_____ (*trustworthy, compassion, self-discipline)*, people listened to her. In 1881, Clara Barton founded the American Red Cross. She became its first president and led the organization for 23 years.

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